IT Support Field Guide

Muhammad Musa | Portfolio samples | October 2026

A practical set of support templates, checklists and illustrative network diagrams.

All examples are demonstrations. They are not employer records. Use the editable Markdown and spreadsheet files for operational adaptation.

Included templates

Onboarding Offboarding Checklist

IT Incident Report Template

Preventive Maintenance Checklist

Network Documentation Template

Device Troubleshooting Decision Tree

Backup Verification Checklist

Microsoft 365 User Support Guide

Windows Support Checklist

Digital Filing Structure

The Excel workbook and separate CSV files add asset tracking, a helpdesk tracker, a learning risk register and vendor comparison.

User onboarding and offboarding checklist

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Request record

Field	Entry
Request ID	
Staff reference / role	
Department / manager	
Start or last working date	
Request type	Onboarding / Offboarding
Approved by / approval date	
Technician / ticket reference	

Onboarding

[ ] Confirm the approved start date and access request with the manager.
[ ] Record the assigned device ID, serial number and condition.
[ ] Apply approved updates and check required workplace applications.
[ ] Create or request the approved account through the authorised administrator.
[ ] Confirm the email account and approved software licences are available.
[ ] Provide only the access approved for the role.
[ ] Help the user complete the organisation's MFA setup where applicable.
[ ] Test sign-in, email, printing and required shared resources with the user.
[ ] Explain how to request support and report suspicious messages.
[ ] Record the handover and obtain acknowledgement.

Offboarding

[ ] Confirm the authorised last-access time and responsible approver.
[ ] Arrange ownership/retention of work records under the organisation's policy.
[ ] Request or perform approved account disablement and session revocation.
[ ] Remove role-specific application and shared-resource access as authorised.
[ ] Collect devices, peripherals and access items; record condition and device IDs.
[ ] Record unreturned items and assign a follow-up owner.
[ ] Update the asset register and approved licence records.
[ ] Confirm completion with the manager and record unresolved actions.

Completion record

Action	Owner	Date completed	Evidence / ticket	Outstanding action
Account and access				
Device and assets				
Records handover				
Manager acknowledgement				

Close the request only when the required approvals and actions are recorded. Do not enter passwords, recovery codes or personal authentication secrets in this checklist.

IT incident report

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Incident record

Field	Entry
Incident / ticket ID	
Reported by / contact route	
Reported date and time / timezone	
Affected service / device reference	
Affected users / operational impact	
Severity and reason	
Assigned owner	
Current status	

Observed issue

Record the exact symptom, when it began and any error message. Separate what was observed from a suspected explanation.

Timeline and checks

Date / time / timezone	Observation or action	Person / team reference	Result	Next step

Investigation

- What was expected?
- What actually happened?
- Which users, devices and services are affected?
- What changed before the symptom appeared, if known?
- Which checks were completed and what did each show?
- What remains unconfirmed?

Response and escalation

Record approved actions, responsible owners, the escalation route and any user communication. Preserve evidence in the approved internal location; include only a restricted reference here.

Outcome

State whether service was restored, a workaround was provided or technical follow-up remains open. Record the verification check and user confirmation where relevant.

Follow-up

Required action	Owner	Due date	Completion / evidence

Closure

[ ] Outcome verified or an authorised follow-up accepted.

[ ] User or service owner updated.

[ ] Required evidence and service records retained appropriately.

[ ] Closure owner and time recorded.

Never place live credentials or confidential incident evidence in a public portfolio copy.

Preventive maintenance checklist

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Maintenance record

Field	Entry
Device ID / device type	
Assigned user / department	
Technician / check date	
Approved maintenance window	
Previous maintenance reference	

Device and workplace checks

[ ] Confirm the device ID and record existing damage or user-reported problems.

[ ] Check power connections, ventilation and external condition.

[ ] Check available storage and relevant health warnings.

[ ] Confirm approved operating-system and application updates.

[ ] Check the organisation's endpoint-protection status.

[ ] Check required workplace applications and peripherals.

[ ] Check network connectivity and access to approved resources.

[ ] Verify backup status where the device is within the backup scope.

[ ] Record maintenance needs, replacement requirements and responsible owners.

[ ] Confirm normal user tasks still work after approved changes.

Record of checks

Check	Result: OK / Issue / Not applicable	Evidence or note	Required action	Owner / due date
Hardware and power				
Storage				
Updates				
Protection				
Connectivity				
Backup scope/status				
Peripherals				

Handover

Record changes made, unresolved faults, the next review date and any user acknowledgement. Do not open hardware, remove software or change security settings without the relevant authorisation.

Network documentation template

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Document control

Field	Entry
Site / document owner	
Version / review date	
Approved storage location	
Change / support reference	

Environment overview

Describe the internet service, router/firewall, switching, wireless coverage, server/client environment and the business services that depend on them.

Equipment register

Device reference	Device role	Make / model	General location	Support owner	Maintenance note
DEMO-ROUTER-01	Internet router	Demo equipment	Office	Demo technician	Fictional example

Connectivity and dependencies

Source role	Destination role	Connection type	Service purpose	Support contact reference
Internet router	Office switch	Wired	Office connectivity	Demo provider reference
Office switch	Wireless access point	Wired	Staff Wi-Fi	Demo technician

Support checks

- Confirm whether one device, one area or the whole site is affected.
- Record link/power indicators and the user-visible symptom.
- Distinguish local connectivity, internet access and business-service access.
- Record checks, results and escalation ownership.

Change log

Date	Approved change	Owner	Verification	Rollback / follow-up

Keep addressing, credentials, access keys and detailed security configuration in a separate approved internal record. Public portfolio copies should show device roles and illustrative topology only. See the accompanying small-office diagram.

Device troubleshooting decision tree

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Initial checks

1. Record the user-visible symptom, device reference and effect on work.
2. Confirm whether there is a power, damage or electrical safety concern. Stop use and escalate if present.
3. Identify whether the device powers on.

If the device does not power on

Check the approved power source, external cable and adapter connection. Record indicators and symptoms. Escalate unresolved power/hardware faults. Do not open electrical equipment beyond your authorised service scope.

If the device powers on

Identify the affected area: operating system, application, peripheral or connectivity. Compare the symptom with a known working state and record the exact error.

Test and follow through

Use an appropriate low-impact check, obtain approval for changes where needed, record the result and test the original user task. If unresolved, escalate with the checks already completed. Close only after verification or an agreed handover.

The SVG file shows this same decision path as a diagram.

Backup verification checklist

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Backup scope

Field	Entry
Service / dataset reference	
Backup owner / support contact	
Required schedule / retention	
Approved destination reference	
Check date and time / timezone	
Recovery requirement / policy reference	

Verification

[ ] Confirm that the dataset is included in the approved backup scope.

[ ] Review the latest job status and record the time and result.

[ ] Check that required files or services are included, not just that a job completed.

[ ] Check retention coverage and whether exceptions were reported.

[ ] Confirm that authorised personnel can access the backup record.

[ ] Review the last approved recovery-test result.

[ ] If authorised, restore a test copy to an isolated approved location.

[ ] Check that the restored item opens and matches the intended test version.

[ ] Record failures, missing coverage and responsible follow-up owners.

Evidence and follow-up

Check	Evidence reference	Result	Action / owner	Due date
Job status				
Scope / retention				
Recovery test				

A completed job and a successful recovery test are different evidence. Do not overwrite production data or expose backup locations and credentials in public copies.

Microsoft 365 user support guide

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Purpose

First-line support checks for a user-facing problem. Administration changes require the appropriate role and approval.

Capture the issue

Record the affected application, sign-in account type, device, start time, error text and whether other users are affected. Never ask a user to disclose a password or MFA code.

Sign-in

1. Confirm the expected work/school account and that the device has internet access.
2. Record the error code and time. Distinguish one application from a wider sign-in issue.
3. Check whether the user can reach the service in a supported browser.
4. If authorised, check service health and relevant account/licence status.
5. Escalate persistent errors with the time, error code, affected application and completed checks. MFA or policy changes belong with the authorised administrator.

Outlook or email

Check the reported symptom: connection, sending, receiving, repeated sign-in or one message. Compare browser access with the desktop application. Record any delivery-report code and use the current Microsoft troubleshooting resources. Do not delete a profile or data without an approved recovery plan.

File access or sync

Confirm the correct account, file location, permission owner and whether access works in the browser. Record any sync status/error and available device storage. Escalate permission changes through the approved owner. Do not make confidential content public to bypass access problems.

Handover record

Symptom / service	Checks and results	Approved action	Outcome	Next owner

Official reference

Microsoft: Outlook connectivity troubleshooting resources

This sample demonstrates a support process. It is not evidence of advanced Microsoft 365 or identity engineering.

Windows support checklist

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Ticket record

Record device ID, Windows version where relevant, symptom, exact error, affected application, first occurrence and recent changes reported by the user.

Initial checks

[ ] Confirm power, cable and peripheral connections.

[ ] Confirm whether the problem affects one device or multiple users.

[ ] Check the relevant application and available storage.

[ ] Record network status where the task requires connectivity.

[ ] Check whether the account has approved access to the required resource.

[ ] Review relevant error messages and existing service records.

[ ] Check approved update/restart status, with the user's work saved first.

[ ] Make only appropriate authorised changes and record them.

Verify and close

[ ] Reproduce the original user task after the change.

[ ] Confirm the outcome with the user.

[ ] Record what was checked, changed and left unresolved.

[ ] Escalate persistent or security-related symptoms with useful evidence.

Change record

Time	Check / approved change	Result	Follow-up

Do not disable protection, erase user data or reinstall the operating system as a routine first check. Follow the approved support process and recovery arrangements.

Digital filing structure

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Demonstration template. No employer records or real user data.

Demonstration folder plan

Folder	Contents	Owner	Review rule
01_Admin	Approved office templates and correspondence	Operations owner	Review template changes
02_IT_Support	Procedures, service summaries and user guides	IT support owner	Review after changes
03_Assets	Device register and maintenance records	Asset-record owner	Update at handover
04_Projects	One folder per approved project	Project owner	Review at milestones
05_Vendors	Quotations and service records	Procurement owner	Review before purchase
06_Reports	Periodic approved reports	Report owner	Review before release
99_Archive	Closed records retained under policy	Records owner	Review retention date

Naming pattern

Use a sortable date, subject and version when a date is useful. Example: 2026-10-24_Device_Maintenance_v01.md. Use DRAFT or APPROVED only when that status has a defined owner.

Record index

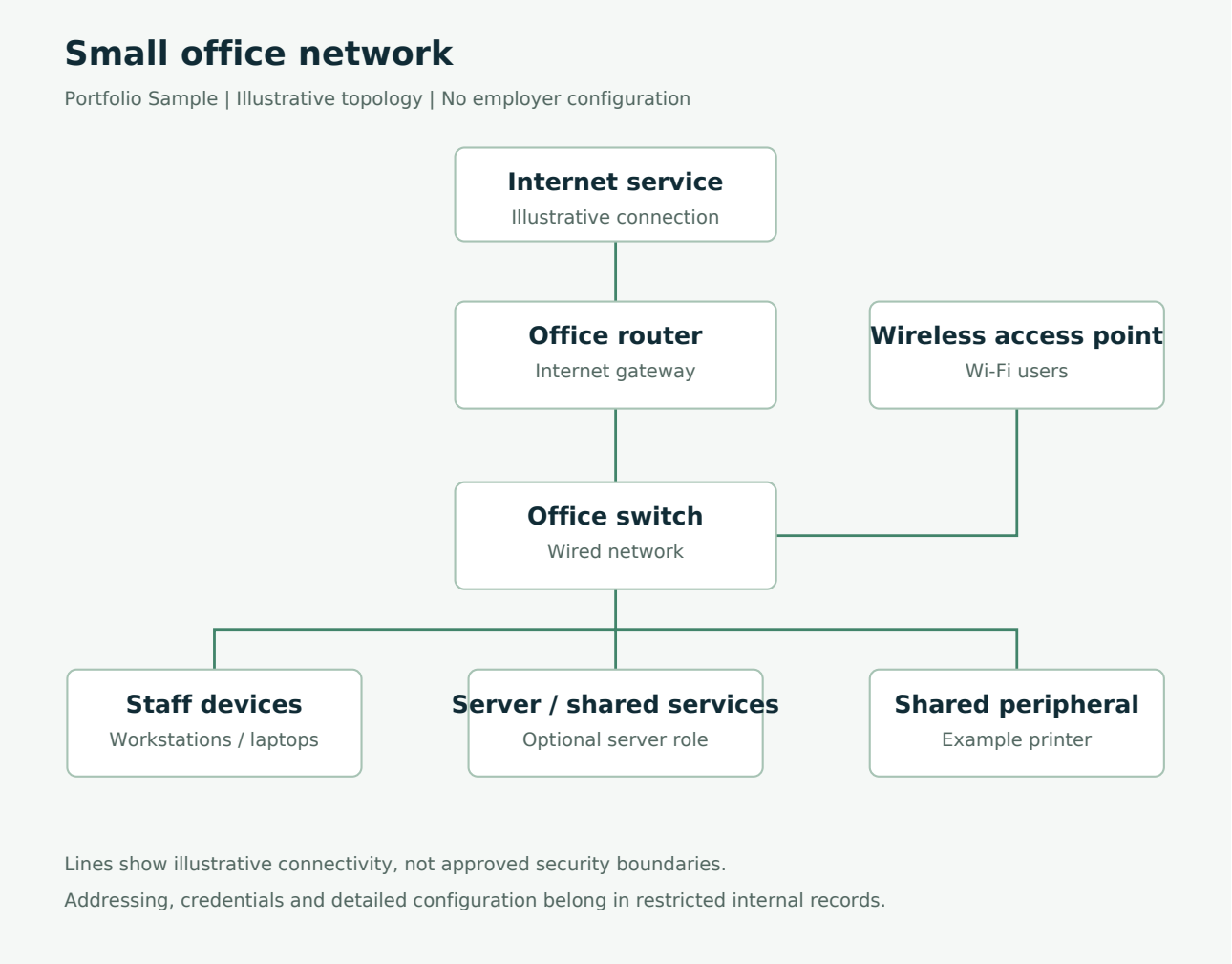
Record ID	File name / relative path	Owner	Status	Review date	Access group
DEMO-DOC-001	02_IT_Support/Windows_Support_Guide.md	Demo IT owner	Draft	2026-11-24	Demo staff

Working rules

- Give each working record one agreed location and owner.
- Separate approved templates from completed operational records.
- Limit sensitive records to the approved access group.
- Record version and review ownership; avoid duplicate final copies.
- Apply the organisation's retention and backup policy.

This is a sample filing plan, not a record of an employer's folder structure.

Small office network diagram



Device troubleshooting decision tree

